

Higher education simulation: worker brief

Day 4 · Session 4 | Higher education | Assigned-role brief

YOUR ROLE: Worker / union team

FICTIONAL TRAINING EXERCISE. Use only your assigned role. A role label separates downloads for the exercise; files on this public website are accessible to anyone with the link.

PLENARY B — WORKER-SIDE CONFIDENTIAL BRIEF (higher education)

Do not read: the separate employer-side download.

Your mandate: Obtain written acknowledgement that the arrears are a contractual entitlement, not a discretionary payment, and a payment schedule of no more than three instalments.

Your walk-away: You may not accept an outcome that treats the arrears as negotiable in principle. Timing is negotiable; entitlement is not.

What you know that they may not: Two comparable institutions cleared equivalent arrears within eighteen months. You have the figures for one of them and can cite it.

Your pressure: Members are asking why the union has not escalated. Some are considering individual legal claims, which would fragment your position and cost more overall.

What you could accept: Three instalments over two financial years. Interest waived in exchange for a firm schedule. A joint monitoring mechanism instead of immediate full payment.

What you cannot accept: Any formulation describing the arrears as subject to available funds without a backstop date.

Quietly: You recognize the institution's constraint is real. Your concern is that a vague commitment will slip again, as it did before. A credible monitoring mechanism may be worth more to you than a faster schedule — but do not concede that early.